Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-06

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 2:9-16

9 "Yet it was I who destroyed the Amorite before them, whose height was like the height of the cedars, and he was as strong as the oaks; yet I destroyed his fruit above and his roots beneath.

10 Also it was I who brought you up from the land of Egypt, and led you forty years through the wilderness, to possess the land of the Amorite.

11 I raised up some of your sons as prophets, and some of your young men as Nazirites. Is it not so, O you children of Israel?" says the LORD.

12 "But you gave the Nazirites wine to drink, and commanded the prophets saying, 'Do not prophesy!'

13 Behold, I am weighed down by you, as a cart full of sheaves is weighed down.

14 Therefore flight shall perish from the swift, the strong shall not strengthen his power, nor shall the mighty deliver himself;

15 He shall not stand who handles the bow, the swift of foot shall not escape, nor shall he who rides a horse deliver himself.

16 The most courageous men of might shall flee naked in that day," says the LORD.

II. Key Summary

• The LORD tells Israel that it was He who destroyed the Amorite, whose height was like the cedars, brought them up from Egypt, led them forty years through the wilderness, and raised up prophets and Nazirites from among their sons (vv. 9–11).

• But Israel gave the Nazirites wine to drink and commanded the prophets, "Do not prophesy!" (v. 12).

• The LORD says He is weighed down by them like a cart full of sheaves; the swift, the strong, the mighty, the archer, and the horseman will not deliver themselves, and the most

courageous will flee naked in that day (vv. 13–16).

III. Passage Analysis

"I …," "But You …"

> God blessed Israel both in the outward, material world and in the inward, spiritual world: outwardly He defeated strong enemies and brought them into a land of rest; inwardly He raised up prophets to speak for God and Nazirites who resolved to live devoutly. Yet now Israel, enjoying material comfort, rejected and suppressed the prophets and Nazirites, showing that they did not want God to be their God. [1]

The previous passage (2:6-8) described how Israel treated the poor; this passage turns to how God had treated Israel. Verses 9–11 keep beginning with "I": "it was I who destroyed the Amorite," "it was I who brought you up from the land of Egypt," "I raised up some of your sons as prophets." Verse 12 switches to "But you": "you gave the Nazirites wine to drink, and commanded the prophets saying, 'Do not prophesy!'"

They took the grace, but pushed away the God who gave it.

Even the Strong Cannot Save Themselves

> Israel relied, against God, on his own strength. … They had despised God, as their "place of refuge", so "the place of refuge should perish from the swift," as though it were not. … God alone "renews strength." [2]

In verse 9, the Amorite "whose height was like the height of the cedars" and "as strong as the oaks" was destroyed by God for Israel. In verses 14–16, the swift, the strong, the mighty, the archer, and the horseman will not "deliver himself."

Israel pushed away God, their place of refuge; in that day, however fast they run, there will be nowhere to flee.

IV. Reflection Question

When you lack nothing, how do you treat the people who remind you to come back to

God?

In those days Israel had not seen times so good since Solomon [3]; amid their prosperity they "no longer remembered the frugal, simple life of the wilderness" [1], and even "gave the Nazirites wine to drink, and commanded the prophets saying, 'Do not prophesy!'" (v. 12). They enjoyed every good day God gave them, yet would no longer hear a single word from Him; so the LORD said that in that day "flight shall perish from the swift, the strong shall not strengthen his power, nor shall the mighty deliver himself" (v. 14).

References

[1] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (Chinese Christian Bible Study), Amos 2 notes (Tang Yau-chi, Tien Dao Bible Commentary – Amos; Tsai Che-min, study notes; Chain-Reference Bible Notes; Ryrie Study Bible notes), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT02.htm

[2] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (Amos 2:14), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/2-14.htm

[3] GotQuestions.org, Book of Amos (summary), https://www.gotquestions.org/Book-of-Amos.html